

BONUS #3

THE FIRST 90 DAYS SELLING ROADMAP

One specific action for every week of your first three months — plus the three points where new sellers quit, marked on the map before you reach them.

VALUE

\$147

COVERS

13 weeks

TIME PER WEEK

About 90 minutes

READ THIS PAGE FIRST · 4 MINUTES

Why Most People Never Get To Day 90

It isn't the software. It isn't the designs. It's that nobody told them what week six was supposed to look like.

Somebody buys a tool, uses it once, publishes a handful of listings, checks their stats for four days, sees almost nothing, and quietly stops. Not with a decision — there's rarely a moment where they choose to give up. They just stop opening the tab.

Everything that follows exists to prevent that. It gives you one thing to do every week for thirteen weeks, tells you what to expect at each stage, and marks the three specific points where people fall away, so you can recognise them as scenery rather than signals.

This roadmap sets activity targets, not income targets — deliberately

You will not find a promise here that week eight produces a certain number of sales or a certain amount of money. Not because the results aren't real, but because nobody can honestly tell you what *your* shop will earn. Your niche, your timing, your taste and your pace all move that number, and any roadmap that pretends otherwise is selling you a feeling.

So every week here is measured by **what you did**, not what came back. Did you publish? Did you review your stats? Did you make the one decision this week asked for?

That's not a lowering of ambition. It's the only part of this you actually control — and controlling it consistently for thirteen weeks is what separates the shops that exist at day 90 from the ones that don't.

The three phases

PHASE	WEEKS	THE ONE THING THAT MATTERS
Foundation	1–4	Getting listings live at a safe pace, and building the habit
Signal	5–8	Learning to read what the data is telling you — and ignoring what it isn't
Compounding	9–13	Choosing where to go deeper, and planning far enough ahead to matter

How to use it

- **One session a week.** Ninety minutes, same day each week if you can. Consistency beats intensity here by a wide margin.
- **Read the week's card before you start, not after.** Each one has a goal, a short action list, and the specific trap that week tends to set.

- **Fill in the scorecard.** Part 5 is a one-page tracker. Two minutes a week, and by week eight it's the only thing that will tell you whether you're actually progressing.
- **Don't skip ahead to Month 3.** The niche-expansion decisions in weeks 9–13 depend on data you'll only have if you did weeks 1–8 properly.

Before week one

This roadmap assumes your shop is open and set up correctly, and that you know how to publish without tripping a policy flag. If either isn't true yet, stop here and work through **Bonus #1 (The Etsy Shop Approval & Setup Kit)** and **Bonus #2 (The Seller Protection Playbook)** first. They take an afternoon between them, and week one assumes both are done.

PART 1

The Three Quit Points

Read this part now, before week one — not when you get there. Recognising these in advance is most of the work.

-
- The Silence — days 10 to 14
 - The Plateau — weeks 5 to 7
 - The Grind — weeks 10 to 12
 - Why each one arrives exactly when it does

PART 1

Marked On The Map In Advance

Almost everyone who abandons a new shop does it at one of three moments. They are predictable enough to put dates on, and they have almost nothing to do with whether the shop was going to work.

What makes them dangerous is that each one *feels* like evidence. Read them now, while nothing is at stake, so that when the feeling arrives you recognise it as a scheduled event rather than a verdict.

1 The Silence

DAYS 10–14

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE You've published. Nothing is happening. A handful of views, maybe none. No favourites, no orders, no messages. It feels like shouting into an empty room, and the obvious conclusion is that the designs aren't good enough.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING A new listing has no click history, no sales history and no engagement data, so Etsy's search has nothing to rank it on yet. It takes time for a listing to be tested against real searches. On top of that, a brand-new shop carries no trust signals at all. The silence is the system gathering information, not returning a verdict on your work.

THE MOVE Don't touch anything. Do not rewrite titles, swap images or delete listings in week two — editing resets the very learning period you're waiting on. Publish week three's batch on schedule and leave week one's listings completely alone.

2 The Plateau

WEEKS 5–7

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE Views have started. Maybe a favourite or two. Perhaps one sale, which felt enormous, followed by nothing. The gap between traffic and orders feels like proof that people are looking and deciding against you.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING This is the first point where the data is genuinely readable — and it's almost always telling you something narrower than “this doesn't work.” Traffic without orders is a listing problem: the images, the price, the description, or a mismatch between what people searched and what they found. That is a fixable, specific issue, and week 6 is built entirely around diagnosing it.

THE MOVE Resist the urge to rebuild the whole shop. Change **one variable** on your three highest-traffic listings and give it two weeks. One change you can measure beats ten you can't.

3 The Grind

WEEKS 10–12

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE It works. Sales are arriving. And it's boring. The novelty is gone, the numbers are modest, and the weekly session starts feeling like a chore you could skip once without consequence. This is the quietest of the three, and by far the most costly.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING You've reached the part where the model actually pays — and the part where it stops feeling like anything. A portfolio business is dull in the middle by design: each individual listing is small and forgettable, and the compounding only becomes visible in the aggregate, months later. The boredom is not a sign that it isn't working. It's a sign that it is.

THE MOVE Shrink the session, don't skip it. A thirty-minute week that happens beats a two-hour week that doesn't. And go and look at your week-one listings: the ones you were ready to delete during The Silence are usually earning by now. That comparison is the most motivating thing in your account.

The pattern underneath all three

Every quit point is the same mistake in a different costume: **judging a slow-compounding system on a fast-feedback timeline.**

You cannot evaluate a portfolio of assets by how the first few performed in their first fortnight. The only honest read on whether this is working comes at day 90, with three months of listings and three months of data behind it — which is exactly why this roadmap is thirteen weeks long and not four.

PART 2

Month One: Foundation

Weeks 1 to 4. Getting live safely, and turning this into a habit before motivation runs out.

-
- Your first published collection
 - Building the weekly rhythm
 - What not to touch, and when
 - The first data worth glancing at

PART 2 · FOUNDATION

Weeks 1 – 4

Month one is about two things only: getting a small number of good listings live at a pace that doesn't attract attention, and establishing the weekly session as something you actually do. Nothing that happens to your stats this month means very much — that is normal and expected.

WEEK 1

OPEN, AND PUBLISH SMALL

GOAL Get your first 3–5 listings live and your shop looking finished.

- ☐ Run EtsyEmpire AI on one niche and generate your first collection
- ☐ Review every design properly — keep what you'd stand behind, regenerate the rest
- ☐ Publish **3 to 5 listings only**, spread across two or three days
- ☐ Complete shop policies, About section, banner and icon
- ☐ Buy your own listing to test the download, then note what the buyer experience felt like
- ☐ Add the AI disclosure line to your description template so it's never forgotten

THE TRAP Publishing everything the generator produced. Five good listings beat forty rushed ones, and a brand-new shop publishing forty in an afternoon is the pattern Bonus #2 warns about.

WEEK 2

LEAVE IT ALONE

GOAL Add 5–8 listings and change nothing you published last week.

- ☐ Publish 5–8 new listings from the same niche, spread across the week
- ☐ Do **not** edit, re-title or re-image any week 1 listing
- ☐ Glance at Stats once. Note the numbers in your scorecard. Close the tab
- ☐ Write down three niche ideas you'd like to test in weeks 3–5

THE TRAP This is where The Silence lands. Everything in you will want to fix listings that haven't had time to be tested yet. Editing restarts the clock — sit on your hands.

WEEK 3

OPEN A SECOND NICHE

GOAL Add 8–10 listings and get variety into the shop.

- ☐ Run the niche engine again and pick a clearly different niche from week 1
- ☐ Generate and publish 8–10 listings, varying style and palette from your first batch
- ☐ Group your listings into shop sections so the shop reads as organised
- ☐ Scorecard: log listings published, running total, visits, favourites

THE TRAP Choosing a second niche that's nearly identical to the first. The point of two niches is to learn which direction has demand — near-duplicates teach you nothing.

WEEK 4

FIRST HONEST LOOK

GOAL Add 10–12 listings, then take your first real read of the data.

- ☐ Publish 10–12 listings across the week
- ☐ Open Stats and set the range to the last 30 days
- ☐ Note which **niche** drew more visits — not which individual design
- ☐ Open the search terms report and write down the top five terms bringing you traffic
- ☐ Add any surprising terms into the tags of new listings going forward
- ☐ Complete your month 1 review page (Part 5)

THE TRAP Reading listing-level noise as signal. With 30 listings and one month of history, the only meaningful comparison is niche versus niche. Individual designs tell you nothing yet.

What month one is allowed to look like

Around 30 listings live. A handful of visits. Possibly a few favourites. Possibly no sales at all — and possibly one, which will feel wildly out of proportion to its size.

All of those are the same outcome at this stage: you built the base and you kept the habit. That is the entire assignment for month one.

PART 3

Month Two: Signal

Weeks 5 to 8. Learning to read early data properly — and to ignore the parts that aren't saying anything yet.

-
- Impressions, visits, orders — and what each failure means
 - Etsy's own conversion benchmark
 - The four kinds of search term
 - Changing one variable at a time

PART 3.1

Reading The Data Without Fooling Yourself

There are three stages a buyer passes through, and each has its own failure. Knowing which one you're failing at tells you exactly what to fix — and stops you rebuilding things that were never the problem.

STAGE	WHAT IT MEANS	IF IT'S LOW, THE PROBLEM IS...
Impressions	Your listing appeared in someone's search results	Your tags and title — you aren't matching what buyers type, or the niche is too small
Visits / clicks	They saw it and clicked through	Your first image, or your price relative to the listings beside you
Orders	They bought	Your description, the file/size offering, or a mismatch between search intent and product

The benchmark, from Etsy itself

Etsy's own Seller Handbook tells sellers to expect a conversion rate somewhere between **1% and 5%**, and notes that a good rate varies a great deal by category and price point. It also says plainly that a low conversion rate while a shop is getting going shouldn't be cause for alarm.

Which means: at roughly 2%, one order per fifty visits is unremarkable and fine. If you have 40 visits and no sale, you do not have a conversion problem — you have a sample size problem. Don't rebuild a shop on the strength of forty visits.

The four kinds of search term

Your search terms report is the single most useful screen in the account. Sort what you find into four buckets — each one implies a different action.

BUCKET	WHAT IT IS	WHAT TO DO
Anchors	Terms sending you the most visits	Make sure your best listings are fully optimised for these
Risers	Terms that weren't there last month	Emerging demand — build your next batch around them
Surprises	Terms you never targeted but are getting traffic from	This is buyer language you didn't know. Work it into new tags
Absences	Terms you expected and don't see at all	An optimisation gap, or a niche with less demand than you assumed

PART 3.2 · SIGNAL

Weeks 5 – 8

WEEK 5

THIRD NICHE, AND SEASON AHEAD

GOAL Add 12–15 listings, and start working ahead of the calendar.

- ☐ Publish 12–15 listings, opening a third niche
- ☐ Identify the next seasonal moment 6–10 weeks out and generate a small collection for it
- ☐ Apply your top search terms from week 4 to the new batch's tags
- ☐ Scorecard as usual

THE TRAP Publishing seasonal work too late. Listings need weeks of search exposure before a peak — a collection published the week of the occasion has almost no chance to rank.

WEEK 6

CHANGE ONE THING

GOAL Diagnose your three highest-traffic listings and fix exactly one variable on each.

- ☐ Sort your Stats listings view by visits and take the top three
- ☐ For each, decide which stage is failing: impressions, clicks or orders
- ☐ Change **one** variable per listing — first image, or price, or description. Not all three
- ☐ Write down what you changed and the date. You'll check it in week 8
- ☐ Publish 15–20 listings as normal

THE TRAP The full rebuild. Changing five things at once means that if it improves, you'll never know why — and you can't repeat it across the rest of the shop.

WEEK 7

WIDEN THE WINNER

GOAL Add 20–25 listings, weighted toward whichever niche is showing life.

- ☐ Compare your three niches on visits per listing, not total visits
- ☐ Publish 20–25 listings, with the majority in the strongest niche
- ☐ Refresh the first image on any listing getting impressions but very few clicks
- ☐ Add a second seasonal collection if the first is drawing views

THE TRAP Declaring a winner too early. “Strongest” at week 7 means most promising, not proven. Weight toward it — don’t abandon the others.

WEEK 8

THE 60-DAY READ

GOAL Take a proper two-month review before month three's decisions.

- ☐ Check the week 6 changes: did the changed variable move anything?
- ☐ Rank your niches by visits per listing and by orders
- ☐ Note your overall conversion rate against Etsy's 1–5% expectation
- ☐ Publish 20–25 listings
- ☐ Complete your month 2 review page (Part 5)

THE TRAP Treating two months of data as conclusive. It's directional, not final — enough to decide where to lean, not enough to close a door for good.

PART 4

Month Three: Compounding

Weeks 9 to 13. Deciding where to go deeper, and building far enough ahead that it matters.

-
- The three-question niche test
 - Going deep instead of wide
 - Planning the next quarter
 - Your day 90 review

PART 4.1

The Three-Question Niche Test

By week nine you have three niches, roughly 90–120 listings and two months of data. The single highest-value decision left in the quarter is where to concentrate. Run each niche through these three questions in order.

1 Is it getting found?

Look at impressions and visits **per listing**, not the totals — a niche with thirty listings will always beat one with eight on raw numbers.

A niche with low visits per listing after six weeks is telling you the demand isn't there, or your tags never matched real buyer language. Either way, it isn't the one to double.

2 Is it converting?

Visits that don't become orders point at the listing, not the niche — unless it's happening across every listing in that niche, in which case it's a pricing or expectation mismatch specific to that market.

A niche with fewer visits but a healthier order rate is usually the better bet than a niche with lots of browsing and no buying.

3 Can you actually go deeper in it?

The one people forget. Ask whether the niche has thirty more designs in it that are genuinely different — different occasions, styles, formats, seasons — or whether you'd just be making near-duplicates of what's already live.

A niche you can't expand without repeating yourself is a niche with a ceiling, however well it's performing today.

Deep beats wide from here

Months one and two were deliberately wide: three niches, to generate comparison data. Month three inverts that.

A buyer who lands on one of your listings and finds thirty related designs in the same shop is a buyer who may buy twice, or buy a bundle. A buyer who finds one design and a scattering of unrelated things leaves. Depth is what turns a pile of listings into a shop.

PART 4.2 · COMPOUNDING

Weeks 9 – 13

WEEK 9

COMMIT

GOAL Run the three-question test and concentrate your publishing.

- ☐ Score all three niches against the three questions
- ☐ Choose one to go deep in for the rest of the quarter
- ☐ Publish 25–30 listings, roughly three quarters of them in the chosen niche
- ☐ Keep the other niches alive — don't delete anything

THE TRAP Deleting the niches that didn't win. Those listings cost you nothing to leave up and some of them will sell later. Deprioritise them; don't remove them.

WEEK 10

BUILD THE DEEP CATALOGUE

GOAL Add 25–30 listings entirely within the chosen niche.

- ☐ Generate variations that are genuinely different — occasions, formats, colourways
- ☐ Cross-link related listings in your descriptions so buyers find the rest
- ☐ Create a dedicated shop section for the niche
- ☐ Scorecard as usual

THE TRAP The Grind begins around here. The work is now repetitive and the results are gradual. Shrink the session before you skip it.

WEEK 11

PUBLISH SOMEWHERE ELSE TOO

GOAL Put your existing designs on a second platform.

- ☐ Use the Multi-Format Publisher to push your best designs to one other marketplace
- ☐ Redbubble, TeePublic, Society6 or Amazon Merch — pick one, not all four
- ☐ Publish 25–30 new Etsy listings as normal
- ☐ Note which designs you sent, so you can track them separately

THE TRAP Spreading across four platforms at once. One additional marketplace, done properly, beats four half-set-up accounts.

WEEK 12

PLAN THE NEXT QUARTER

GOAL Work 6–10 weeks ahead of the calendar.

- ☐ List every seasonal moment falling in the next three months
- ☐ Generate collections for the two nearest ones and publish them now
- ☐ Refresh images on your five best-performing listings
- ☐ Publish 25–30 listings

THE TRAP Planning only as far as next week. Everything you publish now is aimed at demand that arrives in two months — that lag is the whole game.

WEEK 13

THE DAY 90 REVIEW

GOAL Take the first honest read of whether this is working — and set the next 90 days.

- ☐ Complete the day 90 review page in Part 5
- ☐ Compare month 1, month 2 and month 3 on listings, visits and orders
- ☐ Identify your three best-performing listings and write down what they have in common
- ☐ Decide your one focus niche for the next quarter
- ☐ Set your publishing target for weeks 14–26 and diarise the weekly session

THE TRAP Judging the quarter on the last two weeks. Compare month against month — the shape of the trend is the answer, not the most recent number.

PART 5

The Weekly Scorecard

Two minutes a week. By week eight it is the only thing that will tell you the truth.

-
- The thirteen-week tracker
 - How to fill it in
 - Monthly review pages
 - The day 90 review

PART 5.1

The Thirteen-Week Tracker

Print this page. Fill one row per week, right after your session, before you close the laptop. It takes two minutes and it does something nothing else can: it makes slow progress visible.

In week two your row will look like nothing. In week twelve, thirteen rows stacked together will show you a shape that no single week's stats ever could.

WEEK	ADDED	LIVE	VISITS	FAVS	ORDERS	TOP SEARCH TERM
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						

How to fill it in

Added — listings you published this week. **Live** — everything in the shop. **Visits, Favs, Orders** — straight from Stats, set to the last 7 days. **Top search term** — the single term that sent you the most visits.

That last column is the one people skip and the one that pays. Thirteen weeks of top search terms is a map of what your buyers actually call the thing you're selling — in their words, not yours.

PART 5.2

The Monthly Reviews

Three short reviews, one at the end of each month. Write the answers down — the value comes from comparing month three's answers with month one's, and you won't remember them otherwise.

MONTH 1 REVIEW — end of week 4

Listings live:

Which niche drew more visits per listing?

Top five search terms bringing me traffic:

Did I keep the weekly session every week? If not, what got in the way?

MONTH 2 REVIEW — end of week 8

Listings live:

My conversion rate, against Etsy's 1–5% expectation:

What I changed in week 6, and whether it moved anything:

Niches ranked by visits per listing:

The one thing I'd do differently in month 3:

PART 5.3

The Day 90 Review

This is the one that matters. Everything before it was building the sample; this is where you finally have enough of one to read.

DAY 90 REVIEW — end of week 13

Total listings live:

Month 1 / Month 2 / Month 3 — visits:

Month 1 / Month 2 / Month 3 — orders:

My three best-performing listings, and what they have in common:

The niche I'm focusing on for the next quarter, and why:

My publishing target for weeks 14-26:

The week I'm most likely to skip, and what I'll do about it:

Read the trend, not the number

The only question worth asking at day 90 is whether the line is going up.

Not whether month three hit some figure you had in your head at the start. Three months of consistent building, with month three ahead of month one, is a shop that is working — regardless of the absolute numbers, because those keep climbing for as long as you keep adding to the pile.

If the line is flat after ninety consistent weeks-worth of effort, that's real information too, and it points at niche selection rather than at you. Pick differently and run another quarter.

PART 6

After Day 90

What the next quarter looks like, and the one habit that carries everything.

-
- The three paths from here
 - What changes once you have history
 - The habit that outlasts the roadmap

PART 6

Three Paths From Here

Day 90 isn't a finish line, it's a fork. Which path you take depends entirely on what your review page says — and all three are legitimate.

IF YOUR DAY 90 REVIEW SHOWS...	THE PATH
A clear winning niche and a rising trend	Go deeper. Same niche, same rhythm, for another quarter. Add a second platform properly. This is the boring path and it is the one that compounds.
Steady traffic but stubbornly few orders	Fix the shop, not the catalogue. Spend a quarter on images, pricing and descriptions across your existing listings before adding many more.
Flat lines across all three niches	Change the niches, keep the system. The process worked — you published, you measured, you reviewed. The selection was wrong. Run another quarter on three different niches.

What actually changes after day 90

- **Publishing volume stops being a risk.** With sales history behind you, high output reads as growth rather than as a pattern worth reviewing. The pacing constraints from Bonus #2 relax.
- **Your data becomes genuinely useful.** Ninety days of search terms and three months of comparison is enough to make real decisions with, rather than directional guesses.
- **Old listings start pulling their weight.** The week-one listings you nearly deleted have had three months to be found. This is when the portfolio model starts behaving like one.
- **The work gets smaller.** You already have the templates, the description block, the tag language and the workflow. Week fourteen takes half the time week one did.

The one habit that carries all of it

Ninety minutes, one day a week, in the diary, treated like an appointment.

Not motivation, not a burst of enthusiasm in month one, not a heroic weekend. Everything in this roadmap — the publishing, the reviewing, the deciding — fits inside one weekly session, and the entire difference between a shop that exists at day 90 and one that doesn't is whether that session kept happening.

Put week fourteen in your calendar before you close this document.

Thirteen weeks. One session each.

You have a shop, you know how to keep it, and you now have a specific thing to do every week until day 90 — including on the three weeks you'll most want to stop.

What's left is making the listings feed each other instead of sitting in separate corners, and knowing which of them deserve your next collection.

BONUS #1 **The Etsy Shop Approval & Setup Kit — complete**

BONUS #2 **The Seller Protection Playbook — complete**

BONUS #4 **The Faceless Brand Blueprint**

BONUS #5 **The Royalty Reinvestment Tracker**

This roadmap is provided for general information only and is not financial advice. It sets activity targets, not income targets, and makes no representation about the sales, revenue or results any individual shop will achieve — results depend on your niche, timing, effort, competition and many factors outside anyone's control. Conversion-rate figures are Etsy's own published guidance and are not a prediction. Etsy's tools and policies change without notice; confirm current details at help.etsy.com. This roadmap is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by Etsy, Inc. Etsy is a trademark of Etsy, Inc.